



SteamOS beta's new features

The constantly evolving SteamOS from Valve now supports dual-boot login, partitioning of hard drives, and more. <http://dgit.in/1hNuw8A>



Case mod 2013

Cooler Master's annual case mod competition winners announced here: <http://dgit.in/ModCM>



This month we highlight some aspiring tech writers and their spirited attempt to get published in the magazine. Let's have more!

Readers' write-ups



Sanjeeth
Gopalakrishnan

The Sudden rise of Indian Companies in Consumer Electronics

Those were the Days when Nokia was ruling the Mobile world with those N-Series models.

There was but moderate opposition from Sony Ericsson. Hardly have I remembered any other brands about a decade back when mobiles were still moderate luxury products and Samsung was hardly considered a competitor. Decks changed in 2007 with the introduction of iPhone. Google introduced Android ; deriving from iOS which led to revolution of mobile industry in India. Samsung slowly increased its market value and became the market leader in quick succession replacing Nokia.

Generally all those companies starting from soaps to bikes , Indian products were always the least choice of preference. Right from looks to advertising ; Indian products lacked that punch to compete with international brands. Although Indian brains are worth enough to occupy 34% of Microsoft in USA , we lacked that individual identities of leadership.

Decks have changed again with companies like Micromax , XOLO by proudly launching products that have shaken the basements of well-established foreign companies. First of all these companies have to take a bow for breaking the jinx. The concept of entrepreneurship has taken a new level; thanks to these companies.

Technology plays a major role in removing the under exposedness in Indian minds. Technology literacy is

slowly vanishing even in remote areas. Even the smallest invention in technology is helping a store owner in some way say example, a Google map. Recently facebook acquired Little Eye Labs ; an Indian start-up company.

It is a contradictory statement to justify this acquisition. It is a proud moment for those people in Little eye labs. Since that company is worth enough to be acquired ; it would have been a majestic moment if it had rejected the offer and continue to function independently.

For all those who say Indian products copy from International brands ; they are not aware that even Android was derived from iOS. Hiring Hugh Jackman as a brand ambassador for Micromax is a wow factor which helps in building international exposure to that brand. 2013 led to the development of Indian companies among India. Every big victory begins with small steps. Lets march together from this February to support all quality Indian brands and be a squirrel in India's development.

Jai Hind !!



Praneet Sab

Create your own URL shortener

Everyone must have tried bit.ly or any other service to shorten URLs but imagine having a URL specially dedicated for

you and your website or business. That would be really great! Moreover it would also increase popularity of your company. Currently there are few sites that provide you the solution to create your own URL shortener at some cost, but why to pay money when you can create your very own URL shortener for free.

I hope you have basic knowledge about HTML and PHP, you should also have installed 'XAMPP' for windows or 'MAMP' for mac, these software act as a local Apache server. If you have purchased online servers then that's also good to go with. First of all let me tell you the whole flow of this script. There are basically 4 files included in this whole process; namely "index.html", "process.php", ".htaccess" & "redirect.php".

The user will open the website say, www.your-site.com (index.html) and will put the long address in the field provided and would hit submit, now this would be processed by another file named "process.php" and it would return the unique short URL of that long URL. The short URL would be like this: "www.your-site.com/1" Here '1' is the unique shortcode or you may say ID. For the server to understand this URL with ID (say: '1'), we have edited ".htaccess" file, which understand the URL and then sends it to redirect.php file which query the database to get the long URL corresponding with that ID; and after getting the long URL it redirects the user to that address. So let's get started building your own URL shortener.

The very first thing that we need to do is to create a MySQL Database. You can give any name to your DB, I used, "urldb". After creating the DB you need to run the following SQL on it. This SQL would create a table named 'urlltable' with two columns, 'id' and 'longurl'. The id column is primary key, therefore it's added automatically.

MySQL command

```
CREATE TABLE IF NOT EXISTS
`urlltable` (
  `id` int(10) unsigned NOT
```